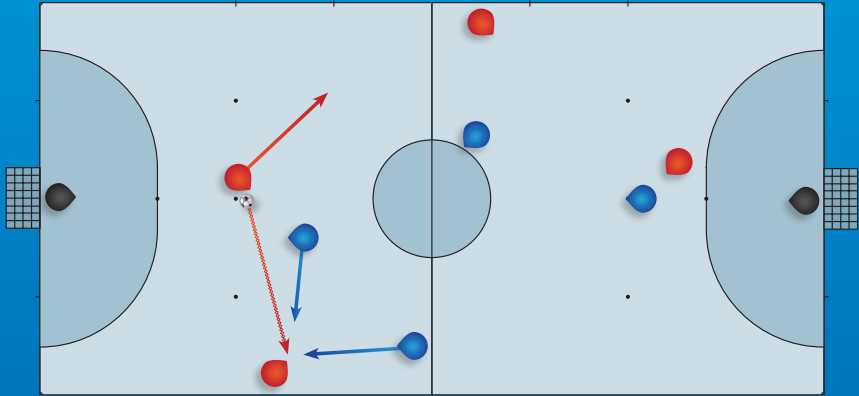


Technical/tactical defensive options for two players

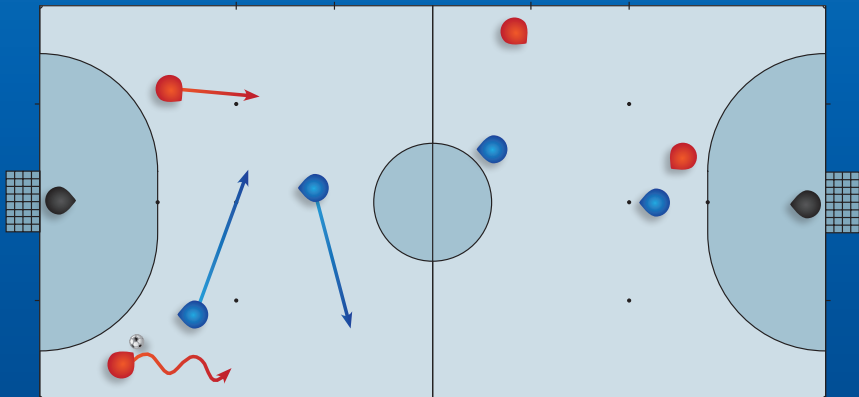
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2v1 defence



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Covering and switching



1.5.2.2 Small-group technical/tactical defensive options

Defence in a 2v1 or defensive support

A defensive move where two defenders work together to put pressure on the player in possession, trying to stifle the opposition and close down the passing angles, and pressing the ball with the aim of regaining possession.

Covering and switching positions

This is a defensive tactical option for two players. A defensive player moves out of position to cover an attacking move or player and their defensive team-mate swaps positions with them in order to provide balance to the shape of the defensive system.

Defending against pairs

Defence in a 2v2; defending against a one-two; defending against an overlap; defending against attacking play in pairs (with the pivot), etc.

Switching marker

When two defenders switch between the opponents they are marking.

Jumping

This is a variation on switching markers and involves defenders 'jumping' from one attacking player on the ball to another, with one defender going to mark the player in possession and a second defender moving across to mark the attacker that the first defender was marking previously.

Two players creating a line of pressure

Two defenders press the ball in a coordinated way and close down the passing angles to prevent the ball from passing the first line of defence.

Defending when outnumbered in a 2v3

A defensive move which is executed by two defenders when at a numerical disadvantage during a transition of play. The defenders take up wide and staggered positions in order to try and force the player in possession to move towards the side of the court where numbers are equal.

Defensive triangles

The rational occupation of space by three defenders, with two players usually forming a first line in relation to the position of the ball, and the third commanding the space on a second line in order to provide cover or to switch marking duties with one of the players on the first line.

Controlling space relative to the position of the ball and the shape of the attack

This defensive triangle can alter its shape according to the position of the ball or direction in which the player in possession is taking play. The coordinated reading of the game by these three defenders is a fundamental core small-group concept in the development of defensive play.

Defensive rotation between three players

This is a scenario that has already been discussed in the context of three defenders covering and rotating. One of the defenders comes across to cover the player who has been beaten, with the other two defenders moving in the other direction to reorganise the defence.

Defending against a three (with a pivot)

A scenario where a pass is made to a pivot, who has two attackers making forward runs. The defence is facing a situation close to their goal with the risk of conceding a goal-scoring opportunity.

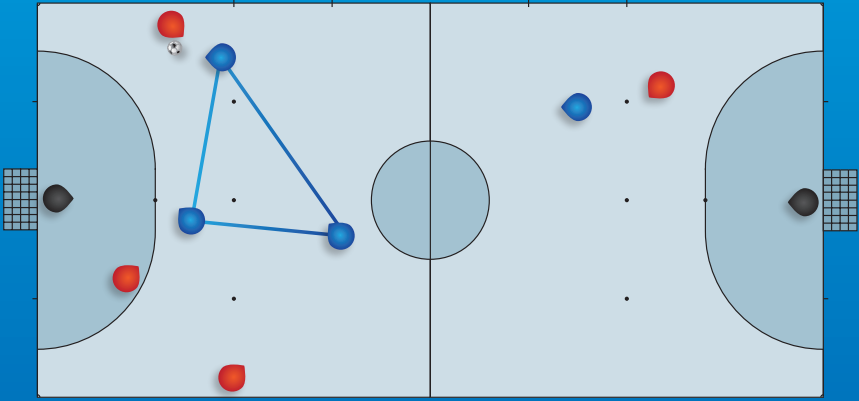
Defending a 3v4

A numerical disadvantage which occurs in transitions of play when four attackers push forward in an attacking transition and one of the defensive players is not behind the ball. Similarly, a positional defence can also find itself outnumbered in a 3v4 when a player has been sent off. This will be discussed and analysed further in the section on systems.

Technical/tactical defensive options for three players

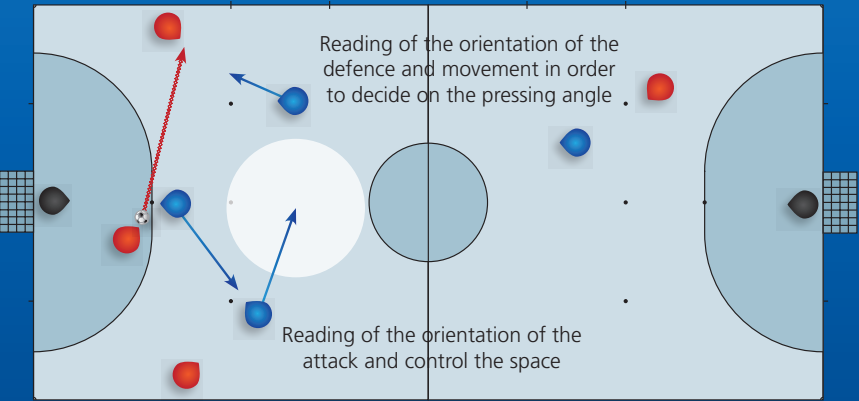
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Defensive triangles



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Defensive rotation for three players covering and switching



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Defensive rotation with three players covering and switching

